

THE DOCTOR

WHEN A GENERATION OF DOCTORS WILLING TO STEP OUT OF CLINICAL PRACTICE BUILT
INSPIRED A NEW GENERATION TO BUILD HEALTHCARE BUS

INDIA'S BIG HOSPITAL chains are raising capital, adding beds and, in some cases, preparing to go public. Yet few of them began as businesses in the conventional sense. They began with a problem.

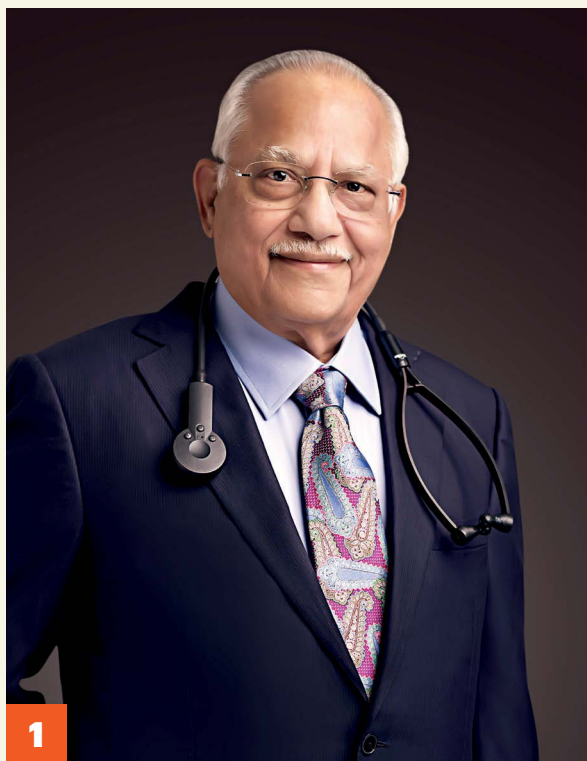
Most started as a doctor's complaint about something that was not working, a patient who could not get treated in time, a procedure that only the rich could afford, a city with no hospital worth the name. The businesses came later.

The scale of that transformation is easy to miss because it happened gradually, hospital by hospital, over four decades. Along the way, the ecosystem around them

changed too. Insurance penetration has widened considerably in that time, private equity funds now treat hospitals as long-term infrastructure assets rather than difficult, slow-return businesses, and government schemes such as Ayushman Bharat have brought millions of families into the formal healthcare system for the first time, with more than 120 million families now covered under the scheme and the government reporting treatment worth ₹1,80,435 crore delivered as of June 2026 across over 36,000 empanelled hospitals.

None of that demand would have mattered, though, without a generation of doctors willing to step out of

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DR. PRATHAP C. REDDY

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ENTERPRISE LTD

(FY26 REVENUE: ₹25,229 CR)

Cardiologist Dr. Prathap C. Reddy founded Apollo Hospitals in 1983 to bring advanced tertiary healthcare to India, at a time when many patients travelled abroad for specialised treatment. He paired clinical practice with institution building to create an organised private hospital network that later expanded into pharmacies, diagnostics, primary care, digital health and health insurance. Throughout his career, Dr. Reddy has championed preventive healthcare, technology adoption and professional hospital management, while broadening access to specialised medical services nationwide.